Dr. Max Heermann

ETH Zürich, Haldeneggsteig 4, 8092 Zürich

max.heermann@gess.ethz.ch • maxheermann.github.io
0000-0001-9332-8336

Current Positions

since 01.2025: Postdoctoral Researcher, ETH Zürich
Research Group on Multilevel Politics
Project: *Public Reinsurance in Multilevel Polities (EUROPE RE)*

since 01.2025: Associated Researcher, University of Konstanz
Cluster of Excellence: The Politics of Inequality
Project: *Conditions of International Solidarity (CONSOLI)*

Previous Positions

04.2024 - 12.2024: Postdoctoral Researcher, University of Konstanz
Cluster of Excellence: The Politics of Inequality
Project: *Conditions of International Solidarity (CONSOLI)*

10.2022 - 03.2024: Predoctoral Researcher, University of Konstanz
Cluster of Excellence: The Politics of Inequality
Project: *Conditions of International Solidarity (CONSOLI)*

10.2016 - 09.2022: Predoctoral Researcher, University of Konstanz
Research Group for International Politics
Project: *EU3D - Differentiation, Dominance and Democracy* (10/2020-09/2022)

Education

10.2016 - 03.2024: Ph.D. in Political Science, University of Konstanz
Thesis: *Preferences and Coalitions in European Union Internet Policy*
Committee: Dirk Leuffen, Gerald Schneider, Andreas Jungherr

09.2015 - 07.2016: M.Sc. in European Governance, Utrecht University
Double degree programme with the University of Konstanz

10.2014 - 09.2016: M.A. in Politics and Public Administration, University of Konstanz
Track: Comparative Politics and Public Poliy Analysis
Double degree programme with Utrecht University

10.2011 - 09.2014: B.A. in Politics and Public Administration, University of Konstanz
Semester abroad: Jagiellonian Universität Kraków (09/2013-02/2014)

Academic Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

Pasquettaz, G., Heermann, M. & Leuffen, D. (2026). The Populist Contagion: How the Mainstreaming of Right-Wing Populist Rhetoric Reduces Public Support for International Aid. ***Journal of European Public Policy***. https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2026.2750197

Heermann, M., Baute, S., & Leuffen, D. (2026). Democratic Backsliding and Support for Public Good Provision in the European Union. ***Journal of European Public Policy***, 33(7), 1981-2009. https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2025.2503973

Steinecke, D., & Heermann, M. (2024). West Lothians in the European Parliament? Diverging Vote Choices in Cases of Differentiated Integration ***Swiss Political Science Review***, 30(4), 472-485. https://doi.org/10.1111/spsr.12631

Heermann, M., Leuffen. D., & Schuessler, J. (2024). Differentiation, Dominance and Fairness in the European Union: Bringing in the Citizens' Perspective. ***European Journal of Political Research***, 63(4), 1622-1641. https://doi.org/10.1111/1475-6765.12672

De Blok, L., Heermann, M., Schuessler, J., De Vries, C. E., & Leuffen, D. (2024). All on Board? The Role of Institutional Design for Public Support for Differentiated Integration ***European Union Politics***, 25(3), 593-604. https://doi.org/10.1177/14651165241246384

Heermann, M. (2024). Undermining Lobbying Coalitions: The Interest Group Politics of EU Copyright Reform. ***Journal of European Public Policy***, 31(8), 2287-2315. https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2023.2249948

Heermann, M. (2024). Civil Liberties or Economic Freedom? The Political Space of Internet Policy in the European Parliament, 1999-2014. ***Journal of European Public Policy***, 31(5), 1368-1395. https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2023.2175019

Heermann, M., Leuffen, D., Tigges, F. (2024). Change to Stay the Same? German European Preference Formation During the COVID-19 Crisis. ***German Politics***, 33(2), 411-433. https://doi.org/10.1080/09644008.2023.2189701

Heermann, M., Koos, S. & Leuffen, D. (2023). Who Deserves European Solidarity? How Recipient Characteristics Shape Public Support for International Medical and Financial Aid during COVID-19. ***British Journal of Political Science***, 53(2), 629-651. https://doi.org/10.1017/S0007123422000357

Leuffen, D., Mounchid, P., Heermann, M., & Koos, S. (2023). Mobilizing Domestic Support for International Vaccine Solidarity: Recommendations for Health Crisis Communication. ***npj Vaccines***, 8(28). https://doi.org/10.1038/s41541-023-00625-x

Schuessler, J., Heermann, M., Leuffen, D., De Blok, L., & De Vries, C. E. (2023). Mapping Public Support for the Varieties of Differentiated Integration. ***European Union Politics***, 24(1), 164–183. https://doi.org/10.1177/14651165221127633

Heermann, M. & Leuffen, D. (2020). No Representation without Integration! Why Differentiated Integration Challenges the Composition of the European Parliament. ***JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*** 58(4), 1016-1033. https://doi.org/10.1111/jcms.13015

Chapters in Edited Volumes

Heermann, M. (forthcoming, 2027). European Solidarity and Deservingness. In: Reinl, A-K. & Nicoli, F. (eds.) ***The Routledge Handbook of European Union Solidarity***. London: Routledge.

Heermann, M. & Tigges, F. (2025). The German Debate on the Future of Europe at the End of the Merkel Era: Governmental Pragmatism and Visions from the Opposition?. In: Góra, M., Thevenin, E., & Zielińska, K. (eds.) ***Political Actors' Narratives on the Reforms of the European Union: Future Visions of Europe?*** London: Routledge. https://doi.org/10.4324/9781003589044

Heermann, M., & Leuffen, D. (2024). No Solidarity without Norm Conformity: Democratic Backsliding Reduces Solidarity and Increases the Desire for Punishment amongst EU Citizens. In: Batora, J., & Fossum, J.E. (eds). ***Differentiation and Dominance in Europe's Poly-Crises***. London: Routledge. https://doi.org/10.4324/9781003291190-15

Heermann, M., Leuffen, D., Tigges, F., & Mounchid, P. (2022). Nur wer sich ändert, bleibt sich treu? Die Europapolitik der Regierung Merkel IV. In: Zohlnhöfer, R., Engler, F. (eds.) ***Das Ende der Merkel-Jahre***. Wiesbaden: Springer VS. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-658-38002-1_18

Work in Progress

Working Papers

Heermann, M., Steinecke, D., & Leuffen, D. Compensation or Contagion? Public Support for International Cooperation after American Hegemony.

Heermann, M., Baute, S. & Leuffen, D. Public Support for the Waiver of Medical Patents: Evidence from an International Survey. (*R&R at Acta Politica*)

Heermann, M. Of Activists and Platforms: Digital Rights Activism, Business Power and Political Alignments in the Digital Economy. (*Annual Best Paper Award 2024, Honorable Mention from the ECPR Standing Group on Interest Groups*)

Steinecke, D., Schmidt, L., Heermann, M. & Leuffen, D. Activated Contact and European Solidarity: How Personal Ties to Ukrainians Shape Support for EU-Level Policies in the Ukraine War.

Haškovec, Q., Freudlsperger, C., Heermann, M. & Hollenbach, D. The Politics of International Moderation: How Leaders Adapt their Rhetoric to Domestic and International Audiences.

Baute, S., Heermann, M. & Leuffen, D. Building Global Communities of Fate: Citizens, Interdependence and Support for International Solidarity.

Baute, S., Heermann, M, Leuffen, D. & Pasquettaz, G. Mind the Populist Gap: How Multilateralists Can Defend Global Health Governance.

In Preparation

Public Preferences for National and International Risk Management. (*with Christian Freudlsperger & Elisa Paepcke*)

Does Mainstream Party Conflict over European Integration Reduce Public Support for Eurosceptic Challenger Parties? (*with Christian Freudlsperger & Martin Weinrich*)

The EU as a Transboundary Risk Manager: From National Insurance to Supranational Reinsurance?. (*with Christian Freudlsperger, Quido Haškovec & Elisa Paepcke*)

The Politics of European Reinsurance. (*with Christian Freudlsperger, Quido Haškovec & Elisa Paepcke*)

Unpacking the Redistributive Chain in International Solidarity: A Vignette Experiment Across Four Democracies. (*with Sharon Baute & Dirk Leuffen*)

Public Support for EU Digital Sovereignty Policies (*with Philipp Bien & Lucas Schramm*)

The European Council – the EU's Supreme Crisis Manager between Efficiency and Equality (*with Lucas Schramm & Thomas Bräuninger*)

Outreach

Popular Writing & Policy Contributions

Maddah, M. & Heermann, M. World Leaders Use their First Foreign Trips to Signal Political Priorities. ***ECPR The Loop***, 21.07.2025.

Leuffen, D., Baute, S., Heermann, M., Pasquettaz, G. Underestimated Solidarity. Public Support for Global Health Policies Is Stronger than Claimed. ***In_Equality Magazine*** No. 8, pp. 22-24, 07.2025.

Heermann, M. The Interest Group Politics of Online Content Regulation. ***EUROPP: LSE European Politics and Policy Blog***, 29.08.2023.

Heermann, M. & Leuffen, D. To Differentiate or not to Differentiate: Public Opinion on Differentiated Integration in the European Union. ***EU3D Policy Brief***, 30.03.2023.

Baute, S., Heermann, M. & Leuffen, D. European Solidarity and the Politics of Blame and Reciprocity. ***Green European Journal***, 11.10.2022.

Heermann, M., Koos, S. & Leuffen, D. Weniger Rechtsstaat - weniger Hilfe: Die Erosion der Demokratie belastet die europäische Solidarität. ***In_Equality Magazine*** No. 3, pp. 48-51, 04.2022.

Heermann, M. Haftung oder Dezentralisierung? Der Digital Services Act und die Zukunft des Internets. ***EURACTIV***, 23.10.2020.

Heermann, M. To Strengthen Democratic Legitimacy in a Differentiated EU, Turn to Transnational Lists. ***Future of Europe Blog***, 18.09.2020.

Media Appearances

RBB Radio Eins. Wenn Demokratie bröckelt: EU-Bürger:innen setzen auf Sanktionen. ***Die Profis***, 24.05.2025.

Teaching

ETH Zürich

2026: Europäische Integration, *BA lecture*
2026: Political Behaviour in Europe´s Multi-Level System, *MA research seminar*
2026: Contemporary European Politics, *lecture*

University of Konstanz

2020: Market Power Europe: Is the EU a Global Regulator?, *BA advanced seminar*
2019: Supranationale Politik im Europäischen Parlament, *BA advanced seminar*

2017: Supranationale Politik im Europäischen Parlament, *BA advanced seminar*
2016: Das Europäische Parlament, *BA basic seminar*

Salem Kolleg

2019: Internationale Politik, *seminar*
2018: Internationale Politik, *seminar*

Professional Activities

Organizer

ETH Zürich, 01/2026: Co-organizer of a joint ETH Zürich - University of St. Gallen research retreat

University of Konstanz, 04/2019 - 12/2024: Co-organizer of a weekly 'brown bag' research colloquium for doctoral and postdoctoral researchers

Peer Reviewing (Journals)

Acta Politica; Big Data & Society; Ecological Economics; European Journal of Political Research; European Law Journal; European Political Science Review; European Union Politics; JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies, Journal of European Public Policy; Humanities and Social Science Communications; Publius: The Journal of Federalism; The Review of International Organizations; West European Politics.

Peer Reviewing (Grants)

Alexander von Humboldt Stiftung: Humboldt Research Fellowship for Postdocs

Academic Conferences & Workshops

Swiss Political Science Association Conference, Lucerne, 2027; GEOTRADE Workshop on Contesting the Liberal International Order: Elites and Public Opinion, Salzburg, 2026 (convened by Andreas Dür & Gemma Mateo); ECPR SG EU Conference, Catania, 2026; EPSS, Belfast, 2026; CES, Conference Dublin, 2026; ECPR Joint Sessions: Workshop on Global Governance in Times of Crises, Innsbruck, 2026; Workshop on the Politics of Pandemics & Health Governance, Leeds, 2026 (convened by Yoshiharu Kobayashi & Tobias Heinrich); Swiss Political Science Association Conference, Zürich, 2026; Italian Political Science Conference, Napoli, 2025; IPSA World Congress, Seoul, 2025; ECPR General Conference, Dublin, 2024; EPSA, Cologne, 2024; ECPR SG EU Conference, Lisbon, 2024; CES Conference, Reykjavík, 2023; DVPW Sektionstagung IB, Friedrichshafen, 2023; EU3D Concluding Conference, Kraków, 2023; Digital Democracy Workshop, Zürich, 2022; ECPR SG EU Conference, Rome, 2022; EUSA Conference, Miami, 2022; Digital Sovereignity Workshop Vienna, 2022 (convened by Gerda Falkner et al.); ECPR General Conference (online), 2021; ECPR SG Interest Groups Summer School (online), 2021; Digital Democracy Workshop, Zürich, 2020; ECPR SG Parliaments Workshop, Konstanz, 2019; Politicologenetmaal: Annual Political Science Workshops of the Low Countries, Antwerp, 2019

Invited Talks

12/2025: "Democratic Backsliding and Suppot for Public Good Provision in the European Union", TRUEDEM Webinar Series organized by the 'Trust in European Democracies' Horizon Europe Consortium

01/2022: "Der Rechtsstaatlichkeits-Konflikt zwischen Polen und der Europäischen Union aus politikwissenschaftlicher Sicht", European Law Students Association & Young European Federalists Konstanz

Languages & Skills

Languages: German (native), English (proficient), French (intermediate, B2)

Data Science: R, Stata

References

Dirk Leuffen
Professor of Political Science/International Politics
Department of Politics and Public Administration
University of Konstanz

Frank Schimmelfennig
Professor of European Politics
Department of Humanities, Social and Political Sciences
ETH Zürich

Christian Freudlsperger
Professor of European and International Politics
Institute for Political Science
Leibniz University Hannover

Sebastian Koos
Professor in Sociology with a Focus on Social Movements
Department of History and Sociology
University of Konstanz

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